

Chengyu Huang

+1 6073399799 • ch2263@cornell.edu • [hcy123902.github.io](https://github.com/hcy123902)

EDUCATION

Cornell University

Aug 2024 - Present

- PhD in Computer Science
- Research Area: Natural Language Processing; Advisor: Claire Cardie

National University of Singapore

Aug 2019 - May 2023

- Bachelor of Computing; Major: Computer Science; Second Major: Mathematics
- Cumulative Average Point: 4.98/5.0; Rank: $\leq 2/759$; Most Outstanding Graduate

Swiss Federal Institute of Technology in Zurich

Feb 2022 - July 2022

- Exchanged at ETH Zurich and took the courses in Machine Learning, 3D Vision, Natural Language Processing, Convex Optimization, German A1.1, and German A1.2

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Student Researcher, Google

May 2025 - Present

- Worked on enhancing the robustness and effectiveness of preference optimization methods

Research Intern, H2Lab, University of Washington

May 2023 – May 2024

- Investigated Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback for response generation with citations, a direction that aims at enhancing the truthfulness of language models

Research Assistant, School of Computing, NUS

May 2023 – Aug 2024

- Designed and implemented an NLP based credential-taking intention and text brand detector for HTML webpages, which increases recall and precision of an existing phishing webpage detector

Research Intern, NExT++ Research Center, NUS

Oct 2021 - May 2023

- Adapted a model based on GAN and LSTM for response generation in a multi-party context with the help of relational thinking, which was shown to be effective without topic or thread labels
- Designed a global clustering model for conversation disentanglement with contrastive learning and K means, and the model was shown to be more effective than traditional 2-stage models

PUBLICATIONS

Conference papers

- Chengyu Huang*, Zhengxin Zhang*, and Claire Cardie. "HAPO: Training Language Models to Reason Concisely via History-Aware Policy Optimization". *To appear in Proceedings of AAAI, 2026*. [\[paper\]](#)
- Chengyu Huang and Tanya Goyal. "DCRM: A Heuristic to Measure Response Pair Quality in Preference Optimization". *Proceedings of EMNLP Findings, 2025*. [\[paper\]](#)
- Tri Cao*, Chengyu Huang*, Yuexin Li*, Huilin Wang, Amy He, Nay Oo, and Bryan Hooi. "PhishAgent: A robust Multimodal Agent for Phishing Webpage Detection". *Proceedings of AAAI, 2025 (Oral)*. [\[paper\]](#)
- Chengyu Huang, Zeqiu Wu, Wenya Wang, and Yushi Hu. "Training Language Models to Generate Text with Citations via Fine-grained Rewards". *Proceedings of ACL, 2024*. [\[paper\]](#)
- Yuexin Li, Chengyu Huang, Shumin Deng, Mei Lin Lock, Tri Cao, Nay Oo, Hoon Wei Lim, and Bryan Hooi. "KnowPhish: Large Language Models Meet Multimodal Knowledge Graphs for Enhancing Reference-Based Phishing Detection". *USENIX Security, 2024*. [\[paper\]](#)

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- Chengyu Huang, Zheng Zhang, Hao Fei, and Lizi Liao. "Conversation Disentanglement with Bi-Level Contrastive Learning". *Proceedings of EMNLP Findings, 2022*. [\[paper\]](#)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer	EMNLP 2022, ARR 2024-2025, NeurIPS 2025, AAAI 2025
Volunteer	EMNLP 2023, ACL 2024

HONORS AND AWARDS

Sterling Prize Fellowship	29 Jan 2024
A fellowship of \$7000 from the PhD program in the CS department at Yale University (Declined)	
IMDA Excellence in Computing Prize [certificate]	5 June 2023
A cash prize of \$3500 awarded to the Most Outstanding Graduate in the Bachelor of Computing programme from the Infocomm Media Development Authority in Singapore	
Dean's List, School of Computing, NUS	Jan - May 2023; Jan - May 2021; Aug - Dec 2020
Senior Middle 2 Scholarship	Aug 2018 - May 2023

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, CIS, Cornell University	
CS 3780: Introduction to Machine Learning	Jan 2025 – May 2025
Teaching Assistant, School of Computing, NUS	
CS3230: Design and Analysis of Algorithms	Aug 2021 - Nov 2021
CS2100: Computer Organization	Jan 2021 - Apr 2021
CS1231S: Discrete Structures	Aug 2020 - Nov 2020
CS1101S: Programming Methodology	Aug 2020 - Nov 2020

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Contributor and Mentor, RepoSense [repository]		Jan 2021 - May 2023
- Added new features such as highlighting and binary format support with Vue.js, Pug, and css, which enhanced the user interface of RepoSense, a contribution analysis tool of Git repositories - Maintained the project, reviewed close to 100 pull requests, and made 5 product releases, which ensured it runs smoothly with 10 active developers and more than 1000 active users		
Backend Engineer Intern, Global Payment, ByteDance		May 2021 - Aug 2021
Constructed an internal bot that monitors the transaction metrics from a TSDB and sends alerts to the engineers, alleviating the on-call team's burden and accelerating the error handling process		
Developer Intern, Mobile Application, U Wave		May 2020 - Aug 2020
- Developed user interfaces for services such as module calendar and bus timing of U Wave with Flutter and Dart, which became new functionalities of the mobile application - Collaborated in its campus promotion initiative, and invited NUS students to join its existing network of more than 10000 users on campus		

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

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- Skills:** Java, Python, C programming, PostgreSQL, Go, html, and css
 - Languages:** Chinese and English: Proficient; German: A1.2